

Persecution

Christ suffered.

Psalms 69:26 For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten; and they talk to the grief of those whom thou hast wounded.

John 5:16 And therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the Sabbath day.

Christ voluntarily submitted to.

Isaiah 50:6 I gave my back to the smiters, and my cheeks to them that plucked off the hair: I hid not my face from shame and spitting.

Christ was Patient under.

Isaiah 53:7 He was oppressed, and he was Afflicted, yet he opened not his mouth: he is brought as a lamb to the slaughter, and as a sheep before her shearers is dumb, so he openeth not his mouth.

Saints may expect.

Mark 10:30 But he shall receive an hundredfold now in this time, houses, and Brethren, and sisters, and mothers, and children, and lands, with Persecutions; and in the world to come Eternal Life.

Luke 21:12 But before all these, they shall lay their hands on you, and persecute you, delivering you up to the synagogues, and into prisons, being brought before kings and rulers for my name's sake.

John 15:20 Remember the word that I said unto you, The Servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep yours also.

Saints suffer, for the sake of God.

Jeremiah 15:15 O LORD, thou knowest: remember me, and visit me, and revenge me of my persecutors; take me not away in thy longsuffering: know that for thy sake I have suffered rebuke.

Of Saints, is a persecution of Christ.

Zechariah 2:8 For thus saith the LORD of hosts; After the glory hath he sent me unto the nations which spoiled you: for he that toucheth you toucheth the apple of his eye.

Acts 9:4-5 And he fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why persecutest thou me? 5 And he said, Who Art thou, Lord? And the Lord said, I am Jesus whom thou persecutest: it is hard for thee to kick against the pricks.

All that live godly in Christ, shall suffer.

2 Timothy 3:12 Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution.

ORIGINATES IN

Ignorance of God and Christ.

John 16:3 And these things will they do unto you, because they have not known the Father, nor me.

Hated to God and Christ.

John 15:20 Remember the word that I said unto you, The Servant is not greater than his lord. If they have persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they have kept my saying, they will keep yours also.

John 15:24 If I had not done among them the works which none other man did, they had not had Sin: but now have they both seen and hated both me and my Father.

Hatred to the Gospel.

Matthew 13:21 Yet hath he not root in himself, but dureth for a while: for when Tribulation or persecution ariseth because of the word, By and by he is offended.

Pride.

Psalm 10:2 The wicked in his pride doth persecute the poor: let them be taken in the devices that they have imagined.

Mistaken zeal.

Acts 13:50 But the Jews stirred up the devout and honourable women, and the chief men of the city, and raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and expelled them out of their coasts.

Acts 26:9-11 I verily thought with myself, that I ought to do many things contrary to the name of Jesus of Nazareth. 10 Which thing I also did in Jerusalem: and many of the Saints did I shut up in prison, having received Authority from the chief priests; and when they were put to Death, I gave my voice against them. 11 And I Punished them oft in every synagogue, and compelled them to blaspheme; and being exceedingly mad against them, I persecuted them even unto strange cities.

Is inconsistent with the spirit of the Gospel.

Matthew 26:52 Then said Jesus unto him, Put up again thy sword into his place: for all they that take the sword shall perish with the sword.

Men by nature addicted to.

Galatians 4:29 But as then he that was born after the flesh persecuted him that was born after the Spirit, even so it is now.

Preachers of the Gospel subject to.

Galatians 5:11 And I, Brethren, if I yet preach circumcision, why do I yet suffer persecution? then is the offence of the cross ceased.

Is sometimes unto Death.

Acts 22:4 And I persecuted this way unto the Death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women.

God forsakes not His Saints under.

2 Corinthians 4:9 Persecuted, but not forsaken; cast down, but not destroyed; God delivers out of.

Daniel 3:25 He answered and said, Lo, I see four men loose, walking in the midst of the fire, and they have no hurt; and the form of the fourth is like the Son of God.

Daniel 3:28 Then Nebuchadnezzar spake, and said, Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who hath sent his angel, and delivered his servants that trusted in him, and have changed the king's word, and yielded their bodies, that they might not serve nor worship any god, except their own God.

2 Corinthians 1:10 Who delivered us from so great a Death, and doth deliver: in whom we trust that he will yet deliver us;

2 Timothy 3:11 Persecutions, Afflictions, which came unto me at Antioch, at Iconium, at Lystra; what Persecutions I endured: but out of them all the Lord delivered me.

Cannot separate from Christ.

Romans 8:35 Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? shall Tribulation, or distress, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword?

Lawful means may be used to escape.

Matthew 2:13 And when they were departed, behold, the angel of the Lord appeareth to Joseph in a dream, saying, Arise, and take the young child and his mother, and flee into Egypt, and be thou there until I bring thee word: for Herod will seek the young child to destroy him.

Matthew 10:23 But when they persecute you in this city, flee ye into another: for verily I say unto you, Ye shall not have gone over the cities of Israel, till The Son Of Man be come.

Matthew 12:14-15 Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him. 15 But when Jesus knew it, he withdrew himself from thence: and great multitudes followed him, and he healed them all;

Saints SUFFERING, SHOULD

Commit themselves to God.

1 Peter 4:19 Wherefore let them that suffer according to the will of God commit the keeping of their souls to him in well doing, as unto a Faithful Creator.

Exhibit Patience.

1 Corinthians 4:12 And labour, working with our own hands: being reviled, we bless; being persecuted, we suffer it:

Rejoice.

Matthew 5:12 Rejoice, and be exceeding glad: for great is your reward in heaven: for so persecuted they the Prophets which were before you.

1 Peter 4:13 But rejoice, inasmuch as ye are partakers of Christ's sufferings; that, when his glory shall be revealed, ye may be glad also with exceeding joy.

Glorify God.

1 Peter 4:16 Yet if any man suffer as a Christian, let him not be ashamed; but let him glorify God on this behalf.

Pray for deliverance.

Psalm 7:1 O LORD my God, in thee do I put my trust: save me from all them that persecute me, and deliver me:

Psalm 119:86 All thy commandments are Faithful: they persecute me wrongfully; help thou me.

Pray for those who inflict.

Matthew 5:44 But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;

Return blessing for.

Romans 12:14 Bless them which persecute you: bless, and curse not.

The hope of future blessedness supports under.

1 Corinthians 15:19 If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men most miserable.

1 Corinthians 15:32 If after the manner of men I have fought with beasts at Ephesus, what advantageth it me, if the Dead rise not? let us eat and drink; for to morrow we die. Blessedness of enduring, for Christ's sake.

Matthew 5:10 Blessed are They Which are Persecuted for Righteousness' Sake: for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven.

Luke 6:22 Blessed are ye, when men shall hate you, and when they shall separate you from their company, and shall reproach you, and cast out your name as evil, for The Son Of Man's sake.

Pray for those suffering.

2 Thessalonians 3:2 And that we may be delivered from unreasonable and wicked men: for all men have not Faith.

Hypocrites cannot endure.

Matthew 4:17 From that time Jesus began to preach, and to say, Repent: for the Kingdom of Heaven is at hand.

False Teachers shrink from.

Galatians 6:12 As many as desire to make a fair shew in the flesh, they Constrain you to be circumcised; only lest they should suffer persecution for the cross of Christ.

THE WICKED

Addicted to.

Psalm 10:2 The wicked in his pride doth persecute the poor: let them be taken in the devices that they have imagined.

Psalm 69:26 For they persecute him whom thou hast smitten; and they talk to the grief of those whom thou hast wounded.

Active in.

Psalm 143:3 For the enemy hath persecuted my soul; he hath smitten my life down to the ground; he hath made me to dwell in darkness, as those that have been long Dead.

Lamentations 4:19 Our persecutors are swifter than the eagles of the heaven: they pursued us upon the mountains, they laid wait for us in the wilderness.

Encourage each other in.

Psalm 71:11 Saying, God hath forsaken him: persecute and take him; for there is none to deliver him.

Rejoice in its success.

Psalm 13:4 Lest mine enemy say, I have prevailed against him; and those that trouble

me rejoice when I am moved.

Revelation 11:10 And they that dwell upon the earth shall rejoice over them, and make merry, and shall send gifts one to another; because these two Prophets tormented them that dwelt on the earth.

Punishment for.

Psalm 7:13 He hath also prepared for him the instruments of Death; he ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.

2 Thessalonians 1:6 Seeing it is a Righteous thing with God to recompense Tribulation to them that trouble you;

Illustrated.

Matthew 21:33-39 Hear another parable: There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard, and hedged it round about, and digged a winepress in it, and built a tower, and let it out to husbandmen, and went into a far country: 34 And when the time of the fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the husbandmen, that they might receive the fruits of it. 35 And the husbandmen took his servants, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another. 36 Again, he sent other servants more than the first: and they did unto them likewise. ...

Spirit of Exemplified.

Pharaoh, ect.

Exodus 1:8-14 Now there arose up a new king over Egypt, which knew not Joseph. 9 And he said unto his people, Behold, the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we: 10 Come on, let us deal wisely with them; lest they multiply, and it come to pass, that, when there falleth out any war, they join also unto our enemies, and fight against us, and so get them up out of the land. 11 Therefore they did set over them taskmasters to afflict them with their burdens. And they built for Pharaoh treasure cities, Pithom and Raamses. ...

Saul,

1 Samuel 26:18 And he said, Wherefore doth my lord thus pursue after his Servant? for what have I done? or what evil is in mine hand?

Jezebel,

1 Kings 19:2 Then Jezebel sent a messenger unto Elijah, saying, So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I make not thy life as the life of one of them by to morrow about this time.

Zedekiah, ect.

Jeremiah 38:4-6 Therefore the Princes said unto the king, We Beseech thee, let this man be put to Death: for thus he weakeneth the hands of the men of war that remain in this city, and the hands of all the people, in speaking such words unto them: for this man seeketh not the welfare of this people, but the hurt. 5 Then Zedekiah the king said, Behold, he is in your hand: for the king is not he that can do any thing against you. 6 Then took they Jeremiah, and cast him into the dungeon of Malchiah the son of Hammelech, that was in the court of the prison: and they let down Jeremiah with cords. And in the dungeon there was no water, but mire: so Jeremiah sunk in the mire.

Chaldeans,

Daniel 3:8-30 Wherefore at that time certain Chaldeans came near, and accused the Jews. 9 They spake and said to the king Nebuchadnezzar, O king, live for ever. 10 Thou, O king, hast made a decree, that every man that shall hear the sound of the Cornet, [Flute], Harp, [Sackbut], Psaltery, and [Dulcimer], and all kinds of musick, shall fall down and worship the [Golden Image]: 11 And whoso falleth not down and worshippeth, that he should be cast into the midst of a burning Fiery Furnace. ...

Pharisees,

Matthew 12:14 Then the Pharisees went out, and held a council against him, how they might destroy him.

Jews,

John 5:16 And therefore did the Jews persecute Jesus, and sought to slay him, because he had done these things on the Sabbath day.

1 Thessalonians 2:15 Who both killed the Lord Jesus, and their own Prophets, and have persecuted us; and they please not God, and are contrary to all men:

Herod,

Acts 12:1 Now about that time Herod the king stretched forth his hands to vex certain of the Church.

Gentiles,

Acts 14:5 And when there was an assault made both of the Gentiles, and also of the Jews with their rulers, to use them despitefully, and to stone them,

Paul,

Philippians 3:6 Concerning zeal, persecuting the Church; touching the righteousness which is in The Law, blameless.

1 Timothy 1:13 Who was before a blasphemer, and a persecutor, and injurious: but I obtained mercy, because I did it ignorantly in unbelief.

Suffering of Exemplified.

Micaiah,

1 Kings 22:27 And say, Thus saith the king, Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of Affliction and with water of Affliction, until I come in peace.

David,

Psalms 119:161 SCHIN. Princes have persecuted me without a cause: but my heart standeth in awe of thy word.

Jeremiah,

Jeremiah 32:2 For then the king of Babylon's army besieged Jerusalem: and Jeremiah the prophet was shut up in the court of the prison, which was in the king of Judah's house.

Daniel,

Daniel 6:5-17 Then said these men, We shall not find any occasion against this Daniel, except we find it against him concerning The Law of his God. 6 Then these presidents and Princes assembled together to the king, and said thus unto him, King Darius, live for ever. 7 All the presidents of the kingdom, the Governors, and the Princes, the counsellors, and the Captains, have consulted together to establish a royal statute, and to make a firm decree, that whosoever shall ask a petition of any God or man for thirty days, save of thee, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions. 8 Now, O king, establish the decree, and sign the writing, that it be not changed, according to The Law of the Medes and Persians, which altereth not. ...

Peter, ect.

Acts 4:3 And they laid hands on them, and put them in hold unto the next day: for it was now eventide.

Apostles,

Acts 5:18 And laid their hands on the Apostles, and put them in the common prison.

The Prophets,

Acts 7:52 Which of the Prophets have not your Fathers persecuted? and they have slain them which shewed before of the coming of the Just One; of whom ye have been now the betrayers and murderers:

Primitive Church,

Acts 8:1 And Saul was consenting unto his Death. And at that time there was a great persecution against the Church which was at Jerusalem; and they were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judaea and Samaria, except the Apostles.

Paul and Barnabas,

Acts 13:50 But the Jews stirred up the devout and honourable women, and the chief men of the city, and raised persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and expelled them out of their coasts.

Paul and Silas,

Acts 16:23 And when they had laid many stripes upon them, they cast them into prison, charging the jailor to keep them safely:

Hebrews,

Hebrews 10:33 Partly, whilst ye were made a gazingstock both by reproaches and Afflictions; and partly, whilst ye became companions of them that were so used.

Saints of old,

Hebrews 11:36 And others had trial of cruel mockings and scourgings, yea, moreover of bonds and imprisonment: